



Service Bulletin

Customer Service Department

TELEPHONE: 419-661-9000 FAX: 419-661-9639

INTERNET: <http://www.glasstech.com>

Gas System Leak Test

Reference #044

Glasstech recommends periodic leak tests for all of the gas systems we provided, i.e. draft curtains (automotive) or combustion burners (architectural). The Maintenance and Service Manual provided with each system specifies the frequency of the leak tests and the recommended pressure allowed for the test.

The purpose of this bulletin is to stress that the recommended allowable pressure for the leak test, as specified in the appropriate Glasstech Maintenance and Service Manual, not be exceeded. The Glasstech systems are designed to operate at a relatively low pressure, less than 5psi / 138inwc / 345mbar. Pressures exceeding the maximum allowable value can severely damage a number of components that comprised the gas systems.

Before conducting any leak test on the Glasstech gas system consult the appropriate chapter of the Maintenance and Service manual to determine the allowable pressure for the test.

It has been brought to our attention that some users of Glasstech gas systems have used high pressure compressed air to test the equipment for leaks. As a result, many of the gas system components were damaged which rendered the systems inoperable. Use of high pressure compressed air for pressure testing of Glasstech gas systems is strictly prohibited.

Furthermore, use of high pressure compressed air for pressure testing of Glasstech gas systems can damage the high gas pressure switch, and low gas pressure switch, and cause gas leakage through these devices. The wiring for these gas switches is typically connected to an electrical terminal box via a short length of sealtite. If one of these high or low gas pressure switches becomes damaged, and if gas leaks out of these devices, it is possible for the gas to travel through the sealtite and into the electrical terminal box.

This represents a possible explosion hazard.

Glasstech recommends that the sealtite between the gas pressure switches and the electrical terminal box be replaced with an SO cord and gland fittings. This will eliminate any direct path for gas to enter the electrical terminal box in the event that the gas pressure switches are damaged due to improper pressure testing techniques.

The preferred method for leak testing is as follows:

While the system is operating with gas under normal pressures (typically 1 to 5 psi), spray all joints with a soap and water solution and look for the formation of bubbles, or use a gas leak detector. If gas leaks are identified, have them repaired as soon as possible to ensure that the gas system operates in a safe and correct manner.

